

ALEXANDRA CATHERINE MONTGOMERY-WHITFIELD

Principal software engineer and engineering leader with 12+ years of experience architecting distributed systems, leading large teams, and shipping consumer and enterprise products at scale. Deep expertise across frontend, backend, infrastructure, and platform engineering. A pragmatic technologist who pairs long-term architectural vision with relentless execution. Reachable at <https://averylongportfoliourlthatdoesnotbreaknicely.example.com/portfolio/work/2024> for a full case-study archive.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer and Technical Lead 2021-06 - Present
Hyperscale Cloud Infrastructure Corporation San Francisco, CA

- Achievement 1: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 2: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 3: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Led a cross-functional initiative spanning multiple teams and time zones, coordinating engineering, design, and product stakeholders to deliver a high-availability platform serving millions of monthly active users while reducing infrastructure cost by a measurable margin and improving p95 latency across critical paths.
- Achievement 5: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 6: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 7: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.

Staff Software Engineer 2019-01 - 2021-05
Meridian Financial Technologies New York, NY

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- Achievement 6: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.

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LOCATION
San Francisco Bay Area, California, United States

LINKEDIN
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/alexandra-catherine-montgomery-whitfield-engineer>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages

- TypeScript
- JavaScript
- Python
- Go
- Rust
- Java
- Kotlin
- Ruby
- C++
- SQL

Frontend

- React
- Next.js
- Vue
- Svelte
- Tailwind CSS
- Redux
- React Query
- Webpack
- Vite
- Storybook

Backend

- Node.js
- Express
- NestJS
- GraphQL
- gRPC
- PostgreSQL
- MongoDB
- Redis
- Kafka
- RabbitMQ

Cloud and DevOps

- AWS
- GCP
- Azure
- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Terraform
- Pulumi
- GitHub Actions
- Prometheus
- Grafana

Practices

organisation.

Senior Full-Stack Engineer

Nimbus Analytics

2016-08 - 2018-12

Remote

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Software Engineer II

BrightPath Software Solutions and Consulting Group International

2014-03 - 2016-07

Austin, TX

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Founding Engineer

StartupForge

2012-09 - 2014-02

Palo Alto, CA

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- Distributed Systems Architecture and Design
- Event-Driven Microservices
- Domain-Driven Design
- Observability
- Site Reliability Engineering

Leadership

- Team Building
- Mentorship
- Technical Strategy
- Cross-functional Collaboration
- Hiring and Interviewing

CERTIFICATIONS AND AWARDS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional
- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert
- Distinguished Engineering Award, 2023
- Hackathon Grand Prize Winner, Global Cloud Summit, 2022

LANGUAGES

- English (Native)
- Spanish (Fluent)
- French (Professional)
- German (Conversational)
- Mandarin (Basic)

organisation.

Junior Developer (no achievements listed)
Legacy Systems Inc.

2011-06 - 2012-08
Boston, MA

Engineering Intern
Internship Co.

2010-06 - 2010-09
Seattle, WA

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SELECTED PROJECTS

Open-Source Distributed Job Scheduler

<https://github.com/alexandra-mw/distributed-scheduler>

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Real-Time Collaborative Document Engine with CRDT Conflict Resolution

<https://crdt-docs.example.com>

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Project Without Any Description (edge case)

<https://no-description.example.com>

Personal Site Generator

<https://github.com/alexandra-mw/site-gen>

- A small static-site generator written in Go with incremental builds and a plugin system.

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Master of Science in Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence

2009 - 2011
Cambridge, MA

- Thesis on fault-tolerant consensus in geo-distributed databases
- Graduate Teaching Assistant for Distributed Systems
- GPA 3.9 / 4.0

University of California, Berkeley
Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

2005 - 2009
Berkeley, CA

- Graduated summa cum laude
- President of the ACM student chapter

Online Continuing Education (no highlights)
Professional Certificate in Machine Learning

2020 - 2020

SPEAKING AND PUBLICATIONS

- Keynote: Designing Resilient Systems at Planet Scale - Global Cloud Summit 2023.
- Conference talk: The Pragmatic Path to Microservices - QCon San Francisco 2022.
- Co-author of a widely cited paper on consensus protocols in geo-distributed databases.
- Regular contributor to several popular open-source infrastructure projects.
- Led a cross-functional initiative spanning multiple teams and time zones, coordinating engineering, design, and product stakeholders to deliver a high-availability platform serving millions of monthly active users while reducing infrastructure cost by a measurable margin and improving p95 latency across critical paths.

ADDITIONAL LINKS OR DATA

Portfolio: <https://alexandra.dev>

GitHub: <https://github.com/alexandra-mw>

Case Studies: <https://averylongportfoliourlthatdoesnotbreaknicely.example.com/case-studies>

X / Twitter: @alexandra_mw